9.8 Amputation*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I can still feel my foot even though it is gone." **Objective** • Below-knee amputation • Phantom limb pain	**ACTUAL** Chronic pain related to phantom limb sensation as evidenced by pain perceived in the absent limb.	• Less phantom pain.	• Acknowledge that phantom pain is real. • Give analgesics and neuropathic drugs as prescribed. • Encourage massage and desensitization of the residual limb.	• Considered met as pain decreases.
Subjective • "I am not a whole person now." **Objective** • Will not look at the residual limb • Tearful	**ACTUAL** Disrupted body image related to limb loss as evidenced by avoidance and distress.	• Looks at the residual limb and talks about rehabilitation.	• Allow him to grieve and express his feelings. • Involve him in care of the residual limb. • Arrange contact with another amputee or a prosthetist.	• Goal reached when he engages in rehabilitation.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Residual limb	**RISK** Risk for impaired physical mobility as evidenced by risk factors: amputation, pain and prolonged flexion of the residual limb.	• Residual limb keeps full extension.	• After the first day, avoid pillows under the residual limb, as ordered. • Encourage lying prone for 20–30 minutes several times a day, if allowed. • Reinforce the prescribed exercises.	• Met if no contracture develops.

* **References for this care plan:** [17], [32], [35], [37]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.